

F&G - VOL.1

Written by

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FADE IN:

EST. A DINER IN NEW JERSEY

It's mid-morning, a yellow Chevrolet pulls up in the parking lot.

INT. DINER - DAY

GREG and FRED, both 25, sit across the table. In front of Greg a rich English breakfast, Fred only has a cup of black coffee.

Both of them are dressed in jeans and a polo shirt, red and blue for Greg, plain white for Fred.

FRED

Greg.

GREG

What?

FRED

You wanna go up to the Poconos this weekend?

GREG

To the what?

FRED

To the Poconos.

GREG

To do what?

FRED

I don't know. Go on a hike? Maybe even sky?

GREG

You can't ski.

FRED

Says who?

GREG

Says your Manhattan looking ass.

FRED

I've been skiing before.

GREG

When?

FRED

When I was like, I don't know,
fourteen? Fifteen?

GREG

So, even if you have skied before,
you haven't skied in what? Ten?
Eleven years?

FRED

Why are you fixating on the skiing?
It's not like it's mandatory to
ski.

GREG

I just think it's weird of you to
suggest the two of us went skiing
by ourselves.

FRED

First of all, I wasn't suggesting
we went skiing, I was suggesting we
went up to the Poconos. And
secondly, we wouldn't necessarily
be going by ourselves.

GREG

Who else is coming?

FRED

I asked Rachel and I taught you
could ask Lexi.

GREG

Lexi can't come.

Fred looks around in disbelief.

FRED

You asked are telepathically and
she answered already?

GREG

She got church on Sunday.

FRED

She got what?

GREG

Church.

FRED
Isn't she like twenty-three?

GREG
So what?

FRED
So what's she doing in church? Is it like a family thing or something?

GREG
Nah not really. Dad dipped when she was like eight and mom couldn't care less whether she is in church or on some stripper pole.

FRED
Which she is.

GREG
But she's also in church. Plus I enjoy it.

FRED
You have been goin' to church?

GREG
Yeah.

FRED
How often?

GREG
Often.

FRED
You. Greg Scapezzi. The man who used to smoke joints rolled with bible pages is now a devout christian?

GREG
(chuckles)
Never said I was a devout christian. I just said that I enjoy it. I mean, I get it.

FRED
You get what?

GREG
The point of going. Of religion.

FRED
You have finally figured out the
point of religion?

GREG
Kind of. Yeah.

FRED
I am all ears.

GREG
Are you gonna make fun of me?

FRED
I'm positive about that.

GREG
I'm not gonna tell you then.

FRED
Oh come on! Don't be such a baby.

GREG
I'm not being a baby. You are the
one that's being rude.

FRED
Fine. I won't make fun of you, I
promise.

GREG
Okay.

FRED
Go on.

GREG
Don't laugh. Or I won't tell you
shit.

FRED
I won't. Come on.

GREG
Okay.

(a beat)
It's kinda like a bet, you know? A
gamble. You bet one hour of your
life every week and if you're
right, you go straight up to
heaven.

FRED
And if you are wrong?

GREG

You've lost one hour per week.

FRED

Can't she skip that hour for once?

GREG

Of course she can't. That's the whole point.

FRED

I taught the point was that it's like a gamble.

GREG

That's also the point.

FRED

So you got two points?

GREG

No. It's all one thing.

FRED

So... from what I've gathered based on what you said.

(breaths in)

The point of religion is: you take a small portion of all the time you got on Earth and gamble it, consistently week in and week out, on the slight possibility that the one religion you're in is the right one. In the end, if you've perpetuated your bet every single week of your life, you'll go straight up to heaven. Is that right?

GREG

Basically.

FRED

That's so not the point of religion.

GREG

How is it not it? That's literally why ninety-nine percent of all the people that go to church go to church.

FRED

And about that you're right. But it doesn't mean that that's the point of religion. It could be the point of going to church, but that's a whole different thing.

GREG

It's part of it.

FRED

Sure it is.

GREG

What do you think it is?

FRED

What?

GREG

Religion. What's that all about?

FRED

I don't know. I'm not a religious person.

GREG

You don't believe in God?

FRED

What does that have to do with anything?

GREG

You said you're not religious, if you don't have religion, how could you have a God?

FRED

Religion is not about God. I mean sure, they talk about God and what God did and what God will do, but it's all about the ritual. It helps if you truly believe that there's a God and he is the one they are talking about right there, but it's not fundamental.

GREG

So... do you believe in God or not?

FRED

I don't know.

GREG
How could you not know?

FRED
Do you?

GREG
Of course.

FRED
And the God you believe in, is he
the one that it's talked about in
Lexi's church?

GREG
Gotta be that one.

FRED
Gotta be.

GREG
He's the one the majority of people
agree on.

FRED
That's incredibly, spectacularly
inaccurate.

GREG
Yet it's true.

FRED
I guess you could say that.

GREG
So God? No God? Which side you on?

FRED
I guess I would have to say that
I'm an agnostic.

GREG
Agnostic, the lazy man's atheist.

FRED
Are you directly quoting Pierce
Hawthorne to my face?

GREG
You know I am.

FRED

Shit. Okay. I guess at one point, between high school and college, I identified as "Spinozan" pantheist.

GREG

A what?

FRED

Man we've talked about this before. Many times.

GREG

Is Spinozan that jewish man with the weird hair?

FRED

Spinoza. Not Spinozan. And yes. Baruch Spinoza, the jewish man with the weird hair.

GREG

And what's that pantheism stuff about?

FRED

I haven't read him in a while but it was something along the lines of: "God is not personal and not transcendent but immanent, as God is identical to the world or Nature".

GREG

Seems like you read it quite recently.

FRED

I just remember it well.

GREG

And what does that mean?

FRED

That God is not a person nor he resides outside the boundaries of the experienceable world. God is in the world and is the world, as anything, from the stone that is thrown in the lake to the infant who's born from its mother womb, is part of the same, in that they are all revelation of its superior mind.

GREG
Its superior mind meaning God's
mind?

FRED
Yeah.

GREG
That's complicated as fuck.

FRED
That's why I usually go with
agnostic.

GREG
Much easier to just go to church
every Sunday.

FRED
Yeah, it is.

The back and forth stops for a moment. Fred takes a big sip
of coffee, greg eats the last of his eggs.

FRED (CONT'D)
So no Poconos this weekend?

GREG
No we can go.

FRED
Cool.

CAMERA PULLS AWAY FROM THE TABLE AND OUT OF THE DINER.

From the window we can see them starting to discuss
something else, but we don't get to hear what they are
saying.

FADE OUT.

